

Pageflow vulnerable to sensitive user data extraction via Ransack query injection

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Content

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Pageflow vulnerable to sensitive user data extraction via Ransack query injection

- Advisory: GHSA-wrrw-crp8-979q
- Severity: high
- Published: 2022-09-15
- Updated: 2023-01-10

Affected

- `pageflow` (rubygems): < 14.5.2, fixed in 14.5.2
- `pageflow` (rubygems): >= 15.0.0, < 15.7.1, fixed in 15.7.1

Description

Impact

The attack allows extracting sensitive properties of database objects that are associated with users or entries belonging to an account that the attacker has access to.

Pageflow uses the `ActiveAdmin` Ruby library to provide some management features to its users. `ActiveAdmin` relies on the `Ransack` library to implement search functionality. In its default configuration, `Ransack` will allow for query conditions based on properties of associated database objects [1]. The `*_starts_with`, `*_ends_with` or `*_contains` search matchers [2] can then be abused to exfiltrate sensitive string values of associated database objects via character-by-character brute-force.

[1] <https://activerecord-hackery.github.io/ransack/going-further/associations/> [2] <https://activerecord-hackery.github.io/ransack/getting-started/search-matches/>

Mitigation

Upgrade to version 15.7.1 or 14.5.2 of the `pageflow` gem.

For more information

If you have any questions or comments about this advisory email us at info@codevise.de

Credits

[Positive Security](#)

References

- [<https://github.com/codevise/pageflow/security/advisories/GHSA-wrrw-crp8-979q>](https://github.com/codevise/pageflow/security/advisories/GHSA-wrrw-crp8-979q)
- [<https://github.com/codevise/pageflow/pull/1862>](https://github.com/codevise/pageflow/pull/1862)
- [<https://github.com/advisories/GHSA-wrrw-crp8-979q>](https://github.com/advisories/GHSA-wrrw-crp8-979q)

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